

Self-Assessment

AdventureWorks Power BI Trainee Project

Skill Ratings

Rated against the project rubric: Beginner / Developing / Proficient / Strong.

- Data modelling and relationships – Strong
- DAX measures and time intelligence – Strong
- Power Query and data transformation – Proficient
- Report design and UX – Proficient
- Row-level security – Developing
- Performance optimization – Proficient
- Documentation and communication – Strong

Row-level security is the one I'm rating Developing instead of Proficient. The static roles work fine, I tested them with View As and they filter correctly. But the dynamic RLS role uses `USERPRINCIPALNAME()`, and that function just doesn't return anything useful in Desktop - it only works once you've published to the Service and you're on Pro, which I'm not. So I wrote it, I'm fairly sure the logic is right, but I've never actually seen it work. Didn't feel right calling that Proficient when I can't prove it does what it's supposed to.

The Hardest Thing I Built

Probably the Power Query merge from Week 4. I merged Product and Budget to get a Budget Status column going, and I set it up with Budget as the base table and Product merged into it. Looked completely normal - the column showed up, numbers looked reasonable, moved on. Didn't think twice about it.

Except it had quietly broken my TREATAS measure from Week 2. Since a bunch of products share the same category, merging Product into Budget duplicated every Budget row - one copy per matching product instead of one row per category. That killed the row uniqueness on `Budget[Category]`, which is the exact thing Budget Amount by Category needs to filter properly through TREATAS. And none of this threw an error. It just sat there being wrong.

I only caught it because I went back later to double check the TREATAS numbers against the raw Budget table, mostly out of paranoia, and they didn't add up. Took a while to actually trace it back to the merge direction, because that's not usually where I'd look first. Once I figured out what was going on the fix was easy - just flip it so Product is the base and Budget's amount gets pulled in as a lookup instead, which leaves Budget's rows alone.

The main thing I'm taking from it: which table you pick as the base query in a merge isn't just a

formatting choice, it decides whose row count survives. If something downstream (like TREATAS) depends on one side staying unique, picking the wrong base breaks it silently instead of throwing an error you'd actually notice. I check for that now before merging anything.